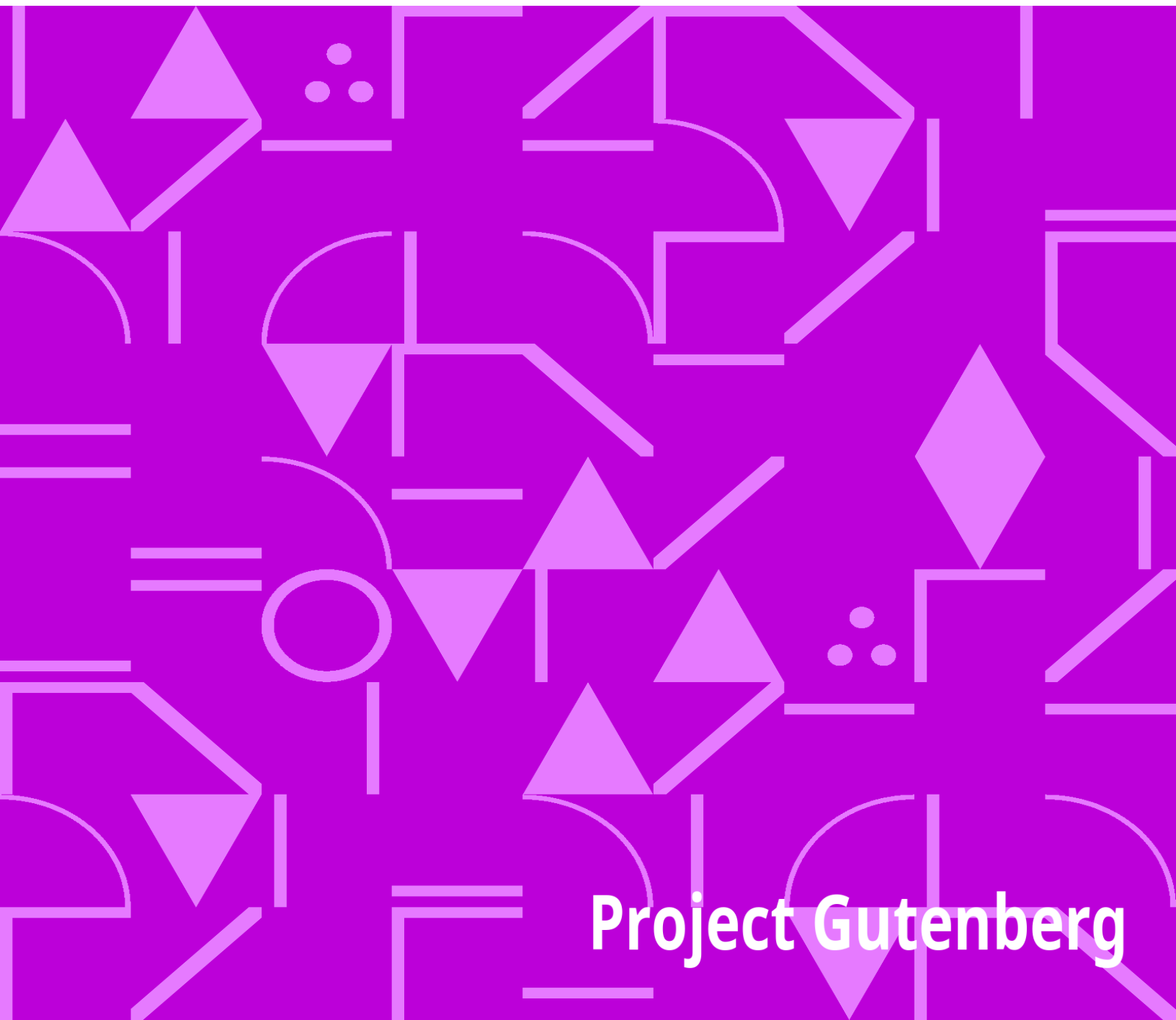


Taxonomy and Distribution of Some American Shrews

James S. Findley

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Taxonomy and Distribution of Some American Shrews

BY

JAMES S. FINDLEY

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by James S. Findley

Sorex cinereus ohionensis Bole and Moulthrop.—In their description of this subspecies from Ohio, Bole and Moulthrop (1942:89-95) made no mention of specimens in the United States Biological Surveys Collection from Ellsworth and Milford Center, Ohio, which stand in the literature (see Jackson, 1928:49) as *Sorex cinereus cinereus*. These two localities lie south of the geographic range ascribed to *S. c. ohionensis* by Bole and Moulthrop. Examination of the two specimens, United States Biological Surveys Collection, Catalogue No. 70566, and United States National Museum, No. 19434, respectively, both of which are alcoholics, reveals that they are referable to the subspecies *ohionensis* rather than to *S. c. cinereus*. This reference is made on the basis of small size, short tail (33 and 31 millimeters, respectively), and fourth upper unicuspid as large as third (the specimen from Milford Center lacks the skull). The occurrence at Milford Center provides a southward extension of known range for *S. c. ohionensis* of approximately 70 miles. *S. c. cinereus* seems not to occur in Ohio.

Cryptotis micrura (Tomes).—Davis (1944:376) assigned a *Cryptotis* from Boca del Río, Veracruz, to *Cryptotis parva berlandieri* (Baird). Comparison of this specimen, Texas Cooperative Wildlife Collections, No. 2765, with 8 specimens of *C. micrura* from various parts of northern Veracruz and with 9 *C. parva* from southern Tamaulipas reveals that the shrew from Boca del Río is referable to *Cryptotis micrura*. The series of 8 specimens in the University of Kansas Museum of Natural History from Altamira, Tamaulipas, provides the southernmost known record of *Cryptotis parva berlandieri*. These 8 specimens are typical of *C. p. berlandieri* and show no approach to *C. micrura*. Average and extreme cranial measurements of 7 specimens from 1 mi. S Altamira are: condylobasal length, 15.6 (15.2-16.1); palatal length, 6.6 (6.4-6.7); maxillary tooth-row, 5.7 (5.4-5.8); cranial breadth, 7.6 (7.4-8.0); least interorbital breadth, 3.5 (3.4-3.7); maxillary

breadth, 5.0 (4.8-5.2). Cranial measurements of 8 specimens of *C. micrura* from various localities in northern Veracruz (1 km. E Mecayucan, 1; 7 km. NNW Cerro Gordo, 3; Teocelo, 2; 7 km. W El Brinco, 1; 5 km. N Jalapa, 1) are: condylobasal length, 17.1 (16.6-17.4); palatal length, 7.1 (6.9-7.4); maxillary tooth-row, 6.2 (5.9-6.4); cranial breadth, 8.5 (8.3-8.6); least interorbital breadth, 3.7 (3.6-4.1); maxillary breadth, 5.3 (5.1-5.6). *C. parva* and *C. micrura* may intergrade but a distance of 140 miles separates the geographic ranges as now known of the two kinds and every specimen examined by me is clearly referable to one or the other of the two named kinds and shows no evidence of intergradation.

Notiosorex crawfordi crawfordi Baird.—A specimen in the Museum of Natural History from Jaumave, and one from Palmillas, Tamaulipas, collected by Gerd Heinrich, provide records of the easternmost margin of the range of this species in Mexico. Assignment is made to the subspecies *crawfordi* on geographic grounds. The two specimens differ from a male from 13 mi. S and 15 mi. W Guadalajara, Jalisco, referred (Twente and Baker, 1951:121) to *N. c. evotis* (Coues) in slightly larger size; however two skulls from owl pellets from 21 mi. SW Guadalajara, also referred to *evotis* (*loc. cit.*), seem to me to differ in no important way from skulls of the Tamaulipan specimens. Measurements of the Tamaulipan specimens, both females, 54932 KU and 54933 KU, are respectively: condylobasal length, —, 16.7; palatal length, —, 7.2; maxillary tooth-row, 6.6, 6.1; cranial breadth, 8.3, 8.1; least interorbital breadth, —, 3.5; maxillary breadth, —, 5.1; total length, 90, 90; tail, 28, 30; hind foot, 11.0, 11.5; ear, 8, 8.

The only other eastern Mexican record of *N. crawfordi* is based on two skulls from owl pellets collected 3 mi. NW Cuatro Cienegas, Coahuila (Baker, 1953:253).

Sorex oreopolus emarginatus Jackson.—A first-year female *Sorex*, KU 54346, obtained by Rollin H. Baker from 7 mi. SW Las Adjuntas, 8900 ft., Durango, seems closest, among Mexican shrews that I have examined, to two specimens of *S. emarginatus* from Plateado, 7600 to 8500 ft., Zacatecas. Measurements of the Las Adjuntas specimen are: total length, 88; tail, 39; hind foot, 13; palatal length, 7.2; maxillary tooth-row, 6.4; maxillary breadth, 4.9; least interorbital breadth, 3.6.

Sorex emarginatus previously was known only from Plateado and the type locality, Bolanos, Jalisco. Comparison of these three specimens with specimens of other species of Mexican shrews of the *S. saussurei* group leads me to conclude that the group contains two species rather than four as was previously thought. *Sorex emarginatus*, *S. ventralis*, and *S. oreopolus* seem to me to be conspecific. All three nominal species are relatively small, short-tailed shrews. The skulls of the three kinds resemble one another in relatively short rostrum and in dental details. Slight differences in cranial proportions differentiate the three and they should, until more specimens of each are obtained and studied, retain subspecific rank. The specific name, *Sorex oreopolus* Merriam 1892, should apply to the three kinds since it antedates the names *ventralis* and *emarginatus*. The two names last given, therefore, should stand as *Sorex oreopolus ventralis* Merriam and *Sorex oreopolus emarginatus* Jackson. The two species, the large *S. saussurei*, and the small *S. oreopolus*, as the latter is here understood, occur together over an extensive region in southern Mexico. In other parts of North America a large and a small species of *Sorex* often occur together in a given area.

The Las Adjuntas specimen was taken only 10 miles southwest of El Salto, Durango, the type locality of *S. durangae* Jackson. Jackson (1928:101) placed *durangae* in the *Sorex vagrans-obscurus* species group, but the two specimens available to him were second year adults with the teeth so much worn that diagnostic characters are not visible on them. I have examined these two specimens (United States Biological Surveys Collection 94539 and 94540) and find that in bodily and cranial proportions they resemble *Sorex s. saussurei*, and I so assign them.

Sorex milleri Jackson.—Koestner (1941:10) reported 5 *Sorex* from Cerro Potosí, near La Jolla, Municipio de Galeana, Nuevo Leon, as *Sorex emarginatus*. Comparison of 4 of these specimens (Chicago Museum of Natural History, 48227, 48228, 48229, 48230) with two *S. emarginatus* from Plateado, Zacatecas, and specimens of other species of *Sorex* indicates that the Cerro Potosí shrews differ in many features from *emarginatus*, but closely resemble, in size and cranial characters, a specimen (F. W. Miller, No. 20) of *S. milleri* from Sierra del Carmen, Coahuila, and seems to be referable to that species which was not named when Koestner (*loc. cit.*) recorded his specimen. The range of *S. milleri* is therefore extended southwestward to western central Nuevo Leon.

Comparison of *S. milleri* with specimens of other species of North American *Sorex* leads me to conclude that *S. milleri* is most closely related to *S. cinereus* Kerr, and should be included in the *S. cinereus* group rather than in the *S. vagrans-obscurus* group. *Sorex cinereus* and *S. milleri* are alike, and both differ from even the smallest *S. vagrans* in relatively long and narrow rostrum, narrow teeth, smaller skull, and in having the third upper unicuspid more often equal to or smaller than, rather than larger than, the fourth unicuspid.

I judge *S. milleri* to be a relict population of *S. cinereus*, isolated in the mountains of northeastern Mexico, probably in the late Pleistocene. *Sorex cinereus* reported from Pleistocene deposits in San Josecito Cave, Nuevo Leon (Findley, 1953:635), probably represents a population ancestral to the modern *S. milleri*. *Sorex milleri* should retain specific status because of constant cranial differences from *S. cinereus*, particularly relatively broader rostrum.

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